Yuanyuan Feng

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RESEARCH AREAS

Responsible, inclusive, and privacy-enhancing artificial intelligence (AI); human-centered security & privacy; Internet of Things privacy; human-computer interaction; health & medical informatics;

TEACHING

Human-computer interaction; usable privacy & security; inclusive computing; AI general education.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

Assistant Professor Jul 2021 – present
Department of Computer Science
College of Engineering and Mathematical Sciences
University of Vermont, Burlington, VT, USA

Post-Doctoral Associate Jul 2018 – Jun 2021
Institute for Software Research (now Software and Societal Systems)
School of Computer Science
Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA, USA

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Information Studies Jun 2018
Drexel University, Philadelphia, PA, USA

M.S. in Information Science May 2013
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Chapel Hill, NC, USA

Bachelor's in Library & Information Science Jun 2011
Sun Yat-sen University, Guangzhou, China

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Face the Fight Initiative – **Business Partnerships to Prevent Veteran Suicide: Increasing Uptake of Discounted Firearm Secure Storage Devices Through Online Advertising** 2026– 2027
- **Co-Investigator (Co-I)**; $108,000 awarded to the University of Vermont. $30,000 towards my lab.

National Science Foundation (NSF) Award – **A Novel Mechanism for Effective and Accountable Communication of Differential Privacy through Multi-Stakeholder Research** 2024– 2027
- **Principal Investigator (PI)**; $599,994 awarded to the University of Vermont.

National Science Foundation (NSF) Award – **A Contextual Integrity Approach for Privacy Reasoning Regarding Performance Tracking Technologies in US College Athletics** 2024– 2027
- **Principal Investigator (PI)**; $175,000 awarded to the University of Vermont.

American Heart Association (AHA) Grant – **Digital Advertisements for Inclusive Trial Accrual (DAITA)** (A project under AHA's IMPACT Strategically Focused Research Network Center) 2022– 2026
- **Co-Investigator (Co-I)**; $832,828 awarded to the University of Vermont; $271,000 towards my lab.

Best Information Behavior Conference Paper Award for publication [C29] 2024
- Awarded by SIG-USE of the Association for Information Science &Technology

The 12th Annual Privacy Papers for Policymakers Award for publication [J19] 2022
- One of six papers awarded by the Future of Privacy Forum

PUBLICATIONS

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW OR IN REVISION

[M1] *Harry, T., Hussain, Z., Ngige, A. A., Foster, A., Mitchell, E., Warren, K. R., ... and Feng, Y. (under review). **Benefits, barriers, preferences, and the use of artificial intelligence in digital recruitment for cardiovascular clinical trials among Black adults: A focus group study**. Submitted to *JMIR Formative Research.* [2025 JIF: 2.1]

[M2] Lahey, T., Wang, N. Y., Ogungbe, O., Hermosilla, M., Ngige, A. A., ... Feng, Y., Himmelfarb, C., and Plante T.B. (in revision). **Ethical challenges of using digital tools to enhance recruitment of Black Americans and other under-represented populations to cardiovascular clinical trials** Submitted to *Journal of the American Heart Association.* [2025 JIF: 6.1]

Notes on publications: In the interdisciplinary computing fields I work in, publications in both reputable journals [J] and top-tier conferences [C] undergo rigorous peer-review processes and are equally valued. Author names are ordered by descending effort towards the scientific contribution, with the PI/senior author appearing last. Asterisk * denotes students mentored by me. Journal impact factors (JIFs) and conference acceptance rates are reported when available.

PEER-REVIEWED FULL-LENGTH JOURNAL ARTICLES AND CONFERENCE PAPERS

[J39] Fox, S.R., Jangraw, D.C., Mascia, G., Gurchiek, R.D., Feng, Y., ..., and McGinnis, R.S. (accepted). **Learning beyond the clinic: Can point of choice visual feedback prompts elicit motor behavior changes in persons with multiple sclerosis?** *Scientific Reports*. [2025 JIF: 4.9]

[J38] *Harry, T., Hidalgo, J., Price, M., Feng, Y., ..., and Danforth, C. (accepted). **A formative study of brief affective text as a complement to wearable sensing for longitudinal student health monitoring**. *Proceedings of the ACM on Interactive, Mobile, Wearable, and Ubiquitous Technologies (IMWUT)*. [2025 JIF: 4.5]

[J37] Plante, T.B., Cao, J., *Harry, T., Feng, Y., ..., Juraschek, S.P. (2026). **Social media influencer marketing as a clinical trial recruitment modality: A tutorial informed by one study's approach**. *Journal of Medical Internet Research, 28(e92813)*. [2025 JIF: 6.0]

[J36] Cao, J., Cha, J., *Harry, T., Plante T.B., Col H., Patil, D., Turkson-Ocran, R.A.,Feng, Y., ..., and Juraschek, S.P. (2026). **Motivational themes in digital advertisements enhance recruitment efficiency in cardiovascular trials**. *Contemporary Clinical Trials, 169(108413),* [2025 JIF: 1.9]

[C35] *Harry, T., Ngong, I.C., Nweke, C., Feng, Y., and Near, J. (2026). **Beyond fixed psychological personas: State beats trait, but language models are state-blind**. Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026. [2026 acceptance rate: 17.81%]

[J34] *Harry, T., Cao, J., Hussain, Z., Turkson-Ocran, R.A., Juraschek, S. P., ... and Feng, Y. (2026). **Guide on selection of optimal motivational themes for use in a clinical trial recruiting Black US adults: A survey study**. *Journal of Medical Internet Research, 28(e75857)*. [2025 JIF: 6.0]

[J33] *Dibia, O., *Lu, M., Bhattacharjee, P., Near, J., and Feng, Y. (2026). **"We need a standard": Toward an expert-informed privacy label for differential privacy**. *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETS)*, 2026(1). [2026 acceptance rate: 22%]

[J32] *Harry, T., Hussain, Z., Cao, J., Turkson-Ocran, R.A., Juraschek, S.P., ... and Feng, Y. (2025). **Randomized comparison of online motivational themes in clinical trial recruitment**. *Circulation: Cardiovascular Quality and Outcomes*, 18(12). [2024 JIF: 6.7]

[J31] *Dibia, O., Bhattacharjee, P., *Stenger, B., Baldasty, S., Bates, M., Ngong, I., Feng, Y., and Near, J. (2025). **SoK: Usability studies in differential privacy**. *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETS)*, 2025(4), 881-895. [2025 acceptance rate: 26%]

[J30] Feng, Y., *Stenger, J., and Zhang, S. (2024). **Contextual acceptance of COVID-19 mitigation mobile apps in the United States: Mixed methods survey study on postpandemic data privacy**. *Journal of Medical Internet Research*, 2024(26):e57309. [2024 JIF: 5.8]

[C29] Agosto, D.E., Abbas, J.M., Feng, Y. Salib, G., Cox, E.D., and Munyao, M.M. (2024). **"We were beaten down": Parents' concerns about children's digital media use**. Proceedings of the 87th Annual Meeting of the Association for Information Science & Technology (ASIS&T'24). [acceptance rate: 32%] 🏆 **Best Information Behavior Conference Paper**

[C28] *Ngong, I.C., *Stenger, J., Near, J.P., and Feng, Y. (2024). **Evaluating the usability of differential privacy tools with data practitioners**. Twentieth Symposium on Usable Privacy and Secuirty (USENIX SOUPS '24). [acceptance rate: 21%]

[C27] Feng, Y., Ravichander, A., Yao, Y., Zhang, S., Chen, R., Wilson, S., and Sadeh, N. (2024). **Understanding how to inform blind and low-vision users about data privacy through privacy question answering assistants**. The 33rd USENIX Security Symposium (USENIX Security '24). [acceptance rate: 17.6%-19.1%]

[C26] Le, T., Wang, A., Yao, Y., Feng, Y., Heydarian, A., Sadeh, N., and Tian, Y. (2023). **Exploring smart commercial building occupants' perceptions and notification preferences of Internet of Things data collection in the United States**. IEEE European Symposium on Security and Privacy. (EuroS&P). [acceptance rate: 35%]

[C25] *Zhang, S., Shvartzshnaider, Y., Feng, Y., Nissenbaum, H., and Sadeh, N. (2022). **Stop the spread: A contextual integrity perspective on the appropriateness of COVID-19 vaccination certificates**. The ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '22). 1657–1670. [acceptance rate: 25%]

[J24] *Zhang, S., Feng, Y., Yao, Y., Cranor, L. F., and Sadeh, N.(2022). **How usable are iOS app privacy labels?**. *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETS)*, (2022)4, 204-228. [2022 acceptance rate: 24%]

[C23] *Gardner, J., Feng, Y., Reiman, K., Lin, Z., Jain, A., and Sadeh, N. (2022). **Helping mobile application developers create accurate privacy labels**. The 2022 IEEE European Symposium on Security and Privacy Workshops (EuroS&PW) (pp. 212-230).

[C22] *Zhang, S., Feng, Y., and Sadeh, N. (2021). **Facial recognition: Understanding privacy concerns and attitudes across increasingly diverse deployment scenarios**. Seventeenth Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (USENIX SOUPS'21). [acceptance rate: 26%]

[J21] *Smullen, D., Yao, Y., Feng, Y., Sadeh, N., Edelstein, A., & Weiss, R. (2021). **Managing potentially intrusive practices in the browser: A user-centered perspective**. *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETS)*, 2021(4), 500-527. [2021 acceptance rate: 19%]

[C20] Feng, Y., Yao, Y., and Sadeh, N. (2021). **A design space for privacy choices: Towards meaningful privacy control in the Internet of Things**. The ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI'2021). [acceptance rate: 26.3%]

[J19] *Zhang, S., Feng, Y., Bauer, L., Cranor L.F., Das, A., and Sadeh, N. (2021). **Did you know this camera tracks your mood? Modeling people's privacy expectations and preferences in the age of video analytics**. *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETS)*, 2021(2), 282-304. [2021 acceptance rate: 19%] 🏆 **The 12th Annual Privacy Papers for Policymakers Award**

[J18] Kim, M.C., Feng, Y., and Zhu, Y. (2021). **Mapping scientific profile and knowledge diffusion of Library Hi Tech**. *Library Hi Tech*, 39(2), 549-573. [2022 JIF: 3.4]

[C17] Colnago, J., Feng, Y., Palanivel, T., Pearman, S., Ung, M., Acquisti, A., Cranor, L.F., and Sadeh, N. (2020). **Informing the design of a personalized privacy assistant for the Internet of Things**. The ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI'2020). [acceptance rate: 24.3%]

[C16] *Kumar, V.B., Iyengar, R., Nisal, N., Feng, Y., Habib, H., ..., and Sadeh, N. (2020). **Finding a choice in a haystack: Automatic extraction of opt-out statements from privacy policy text**. The Web Conference (WWW'2020). [acceptance rate: 19%]

[J15] Shin, G., Feng, Y., Gafinowitz, N. and Jarrahi, M.H. (2020). **Improving patient engagement by fostering the sharing of activity-tracker data with providers: A qualitative study**. *Health Information and Libraries Journal*, 37(3), 204-215. [2022 JIF:3.8]

[J14] *Smullen, D., Feng, Y., Zhang, S., and Sadeh, N. (2020). **The best of both worlds: Mitigating trade-offs between accuracy and user burden in capturing mobile app privacy preferences**. *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETS)*, 2020(1), 195-215. [2020 acceptance rate: 23%]

[J13] Feng, Y. (2019). **The enhanced participant-driven photo elicitation method for everyday life health information behaviour research**. *Aslib Journal of Information Management*, 71(6), 720-738. [2022 JIF:2.6]

[J12] Feng, Y., and Agosto, D.E. (2019). **Revisiting personal information management through information practices with activity tracking technology**. *Journal of the Association for Information Science and Technology*, 70(12),1352-1367. [2022 JIF:3.5]

[J11] Feng, Y., & Agosto, D.E. (2019). **From health to performance: Amateur runners' personal health information management with activity tracking technology**. *Aslib Journal of Information Management*, 71(2), 217-240. [2022 JIF:2.6]

[C10] *Zhang, S., Schaub, F., Feng, Y., and Sadeh, N. (2019). **"It only tells me how I slept, not how to fix it": Exploring sleep behaviors and opportunities for sleep technology**. Proceedings of the iConference 2019 (pp.754-766), [acceptance rate: 34%]

[J9] Shin, G., Feng, Y., Jarrahi, M.H., and Gafinowitz, N. (2018). **Beyond novelty effect: A mixed-methods exploration into the motivation for long-term activity tracker use**. *JAMIA Open*, 2(1), 62–72. [2022 JIF:2.1]

[C8] Caro, K., Feng, Y., Day, T., Freed, E. Fox, B., & Zhu, J. (2018). **Understanding the effect of existing positive relationships on a social motion-based game for health**. Proceedings of the 12th EAI International Conference on Pervasive Computing Technologies for Healthcare (PervasiveHealth'18) [acceptance rate: 24%]

[J7] Feng, Y., & Richards, L. (2018). **A review of digital curation professional competencies: Theory and current practices**. *Records Management Journal* 28(1), 62-78.

[C6] Feng, Y., Li, K., and Agosto, D.E. (2017). **Healthy users' personal health information management from activity trackers: The perspective of gym-goers**. Proceedings of the 80th Annual Meeting of Association for Information Science & Technology (ASIS&T'17). (pp. 72-81).[acceptance rate: 38%]

[J5] Li, K., Yan, E., and Feng, Y. (2017). **How is R cited in research outputs? Structure, impacts, and citation standard**. *Journal of Informetrics*, 11(4), 989–1002. [JIF: 3.484]

[C4] Feng, Y., and Agosto, D.E. (2017). **A survey on management of personal health information from activity trackers**. Proceedings of the 2017 iConference. (pp.370-377).

[J3] Feng, Y., and Agosto, D.E. (2017). **The experience of mobile information overload: Struggling between needs and constraints**. *Information Research*, 22(2), paper 754. [JIF: 0.8]

[C2] Richards, L., Townes, A., and Feng, Y. (2014). **Curation through the back door: Enabling big data curation capabilities in a non-archival organization**. *Proceedings of the 2014 Archival Education and Research Institute*.

[J1] Wu, L., and Feng, Y., (2010). **The applications and development strategies of SNS in libraries**. *Library and Information Service*, 54(19), 24-27. [A core information science journal in Chinese]

PEER-REVIEWED SHORT PAPERS, EXTENDED ABSTRACTS, PANELS AND POSTERS (SELECTED)

[S14] *Rosalan, S.Z. and Feng, Y. (2026). **Gamers and anti-cheat software: An exploratory study on player awareness, security and privacy concerns, and trust** . Companion Proceedings of the Annual Symposium on Computer-Human Interaction in Play (CHI PLAY 2026).

[S13] *Dibia, O., *Lu, M., Bhattacharjee, P., McCallum, C., Near, J., and Feng, Y. (2026). **Can graphical tools help analysts implement differential privacy?**. Theory and Practice of Differential Privacy (TPDP 2026).

[S12] *Stenger, B. and Feng, Y. (2026). **Evidence of college athletes' trust and self-belief attitudes in the gray area of data privacy expectations**. The 8th Annual Symposium on Applications of Contextual Integrity.

[S11] *Dibia, O., *Lu, M., Bhattacharjee, P., Near, J., and Feng, Y. (2025). **"We need a standard": Toward an expert-informed privacy label for differential privacy**. Theory and Practice of Differential Privacy (TPDP 2025).

[S10] *Stenger, B. and Feng, Y. (2024). **Information flows for athletes' health and performance data**. The 6th Annual Symposium on Applications of Contextual Integrity.

[S9] Feng, Y., *Stenger, B., and Zhang, S. (2024). **Post-Pandemic contextual acceptance of COVID-19 mitigation mobile applications in the US**. The 6th Annual Symposium on Applications of Contextual Integrity.

[S8] Feng, Y. and *Stenger, B. (2023). **Applying contextual integrity to elicit acceptance towards COVID mitigation mobile applications in the US**. The 5th Annual Symposium on Applications of Contextual Integrity.

[S7] Feng, Y., Ravichander, A., Yao, Y., Zhang, S., and Sadeh, N. (2022). **Exploring and improving the accessibility of data privacy-related information for people who are blind or low-vision**. The 7th Workshop on Inclusive Privacy and Security (WIPS'22).

[S6] Ilhan, A., Feng, Y., Fietkiewicz, K.J., & Eikey, E.V. (2020). **Opportunities and challenges of self tracking technologies: Understanding information, technology, and users through the lens of information science**. Proceedings of the Association for Information Science & Technology (ASIS&T), 2020.

[S5] Sadeh, N., Feng, Y., Donnell, J., & Misra, G. (2019) **A Privacy Infrastructure for Notice and Choice in the Internet of Things**. Poster/Demo at the Fifteenth Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS'19).

[S4] Zimmeck, S., Story, P., Goldstein, R., Baraka, D., Li, S., Feng, Y., & Sadeh, N. (2019) **Compliance Traceability: Privacy Policies as Software Development Artifacts**. Poster/Demo at the Open Day for Privacy, Usability, and Transparency (PUT 2019).

[S3] Zhu, J., Feng, Y., Furqan, A., Gray, R.C., Day, T., Nebolsky, J., & Caro, K. (2018). **Towards extending social exergame engagement with agents**. Proceedings of the 2018 ACM Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW).

[S2] Kim, M. C., Feng, Y., Zhu, Y., & Ping, Q. (2015) **Quantitative exploration into the diffusion process of creative ideas in economics: Noble Prize laureates**. Proceedings of the 78th Annual Meeting of Association for Information Science & Technology (ASIS&T).

[S1] Feng, Y. & Agosto, D. E. (2014). **Overwhelmed by smartphones? A qualitative investigation into mobile information overload**. Proceedings of the 77th Annual Meeting of Association for Information Science & Technology (ASIS&T).

TEACHING

University of Vermont – Department of Computer Science
Instructor & Course Creator Aug 2021 – present

- CS 6550: Usable Privacy and Security (Spring ’26 ’25 ’24 ’23 ’22)
- CS 3280: Human-Computer Interaction - Catamount Core WIL2 (Fall ’26 ’25 ’23 ’22 ’21)
- CS 2880: Inclusive Computing - Catamount Core D2 (Fall’23)

Drexel University – College of Computing & Informatics
Instructor/Teaching Fellow Mar 2016 – Dec 2017

- INFO 649 (Online): Library Programming (Spring ’16 ’17, Fall ’16 ’17)
- INFO 753 (Online): Introduction to Digital Curation (Summer ’16 ’17, Winter ’17)

ADVISING

Current Graduate Students

- Mengyi Lu, PhD Program in Computer Science, UVM (2024 -)
- Tamunotonye Harry, PhD Program in Computer Science, UVM (2023 -)
- Thi Thanh Thanh Tran, MS Program in Complex Systems and Data Science, UVM (2026 -)

Graduated Students & Lab Alumni

- Brad Stenger, PhD Program in Computer Science, UVM (2023 - 2026)
- Nikhil Sai Reddy Choppa, MS in Computer Science, UVM (Graduated in 2023)

SERVICE

SELECTED SERVICE AT UNIVERSITY OF VERMONT

- **Committee member, Institutional Review Board (IRB)** 2025– present
  Committee on Human Research in the Behavioral and Social Sciences

CONFERENCE PROGRAM COMMITTEES

- **Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETS)** 2027
- **ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (ACM CCS)** 2026
- **Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (USENIX SOUPS)** 2024 – 2026
- **Symposium on Application of Contextual Integrity** 2024 – 2026
- **Symposium on Usable Security (NDSS USEC)** 2023 – 2025

CONFERENCE AND WORKSHOP ORGANIZING

- **PIM Workshop: Successful Aging with Our Information and Our Information Tools** 2022
- **Minitrack Chair for the 53th Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences** 2019 – 2020

JOURNAL AND CONFERENCE REVIEWING

- **ACM PACM HCI Journal/CSCW Conference** (papers) 2021 – present
- **ACM CHI Conference** (papers, case studies, late-breaking work) 2017 – present
- **Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETS)** (papers) 2022 – 2023
- **ACM IMWUT/Ubicomp** (papers) 2021 – 2022
- **ASIS&T Annual Meeting** (papers, visual presentations) 2017 – 2020
- **iConference** (papers, posters, workshops) 2016 – 2021

JOURNAL EDITING

- **Guest Editor, Aslib Journal of Information Management** [2022 JIF:2.6] 2019 – 2020

[*CV compiled on 2026-10-28*]